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Accountability and governance

The Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 got Royal Assent on 19 June 2025. All the provisions affecting data protection law and the Privacy and Electronic Regulations Communications are now in force. The Department for Science and Innovation (DSIT) has set out the commencement plans. You can [find more details on the Gov.uk website](#).

The guidance on this page is suitable for large businesses in the public, private and third sectors. Small businesses should use the resources on our [small business web hub](#).

Brief guidance

[Guide to accountability and governance](#)

Contracts, documentation, data protection by design and default, data protection impact assessments and data protection officers.

[Do we need a UK representative?](#)

Guidance discussing receiving personal information from the European Economic Area (EEA).

Detailed guidance

[Contracts and liabilities between controllers and processors](#)

When contracts are needed and why they are important, what needs to be included and responsibility and liability.

[Documentation](#)

What is documentation and who needs to document processing activities, what needs to be documented under article 30 and how to document processing activities.

[Data protection impact assessments \(DPIA\)](#)

What is a DPIA, when and how to conduct one, consulting the ICO and examples of 'likely to result in high risk'.

[Codes of conduct](#)

Data protection codes of conduct address sector specific data protection issues and support compliance with the UK GDPR. We have detailed guidance and other resources for trade organisations and similar representative bodies who may create codes of conduct for their members.

[Certification schemes](#)

Data protection certification can help demonstrate data protection in a practical way to businesses, individuals and regulators. We have detailed guidance and other resources about certifications schemes for organisations.

Resources

[Accountability framework](#)

Assess your organisation's accountability and governance.

[Sample DPIA Template](#)

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